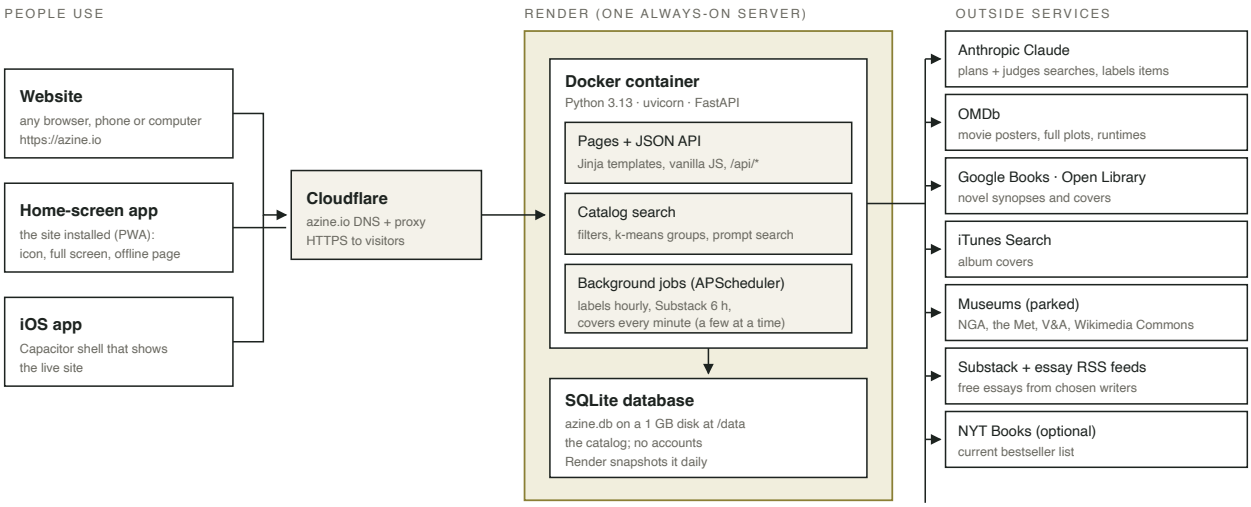
# AZINE System summary

How azine works, on one page

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AZINE.IO · MAIN @ E863F98

**azine** is a catalog of essays, movies, albums and novels (E-M-A-N), the same for everyone: no accounts, no personalized picks, no voting. No feeds, no influencers, no AI-written content: every entry is a real work from a curated catalog. Find things by category, by when the work was made, and by saying what you want.




## How it works

1. **Category, date and country**: any of the four, the years the work was made, and (not essays) where it's from. A plain query, no Claude.
2. **Groups**: each category clustered (k-means over TF-IDF embeddings of genres, subjects, tones, synopsis) into named groups of similar work. No Claude.
3. **Prompt search**, inside those filters: Claude Sonnet plans it (the distinct things asked for, as labels, keywords, typical works, groups); the server lines up every work in the filters, each part of the prompt getting its share (after PinnerSage); Haiku scores each 0–100 and every 75+ comes back.
4. **Background jobs**: label new items hourly, Substack every 6 h, covers a few at a time. Parked: museum art, iOS app, Sunday email (old board at tag `personal-recommender-final`).

## Stack

| PART | WHAT |
|---|---|
| Server | Python 3.13, FastAPI, uvicorn, SQLAlchemy, Alembic, APScheduler, scikit-learn |
| Data | SQLite file on a persistent disk; migrations run on start |
| Front end | E M A N down the left; a click grows the letter into a title card, then its catalog (5 columns, a timeline, "Vibes" search, Met art while it runs). One template + vanilla JS + one stylesheet |
| Hosting | Render (Docker, 0.5 CPU / 512 MB, 1 GB disk), deploys on every push to `main` |
| Domain | azine.io on Cloudflare DNS → Render; HTTPS everywhere |
| Apps | Installable web app (manifest + service worker); iOS app via Capacitor 8 |
| AI | Claude plans (Sonnet) and judges (Haiku) searches and labels items. It never writes what you read. |

## Key decisions

- **One server + SQLite**: simplest thing that works at this size; scales by upgrading the instance.
- **Render** over Fly.io: a dashboard instead of a CLI; Free tier ruled out (sleeps, no disk).
- **A catalog, not a recommender**: no sign-up between a visitor and the work.
- **A 75% bar, not a top 10**: Claude judges fit, because similarity can't tell a mood from a subject.
- **TF-IDF, not a neural model**: separates genres well at this catalog size without a multi-GB dependency.

## Running it

**Catalog:** ~1,900 movies, ~1,900 novels, ~1,800 albums (incl. ~1,300 Latin, Korean, African), ~2,000 essays (+ live Substack/RSS). **Quotas:** OMDb 1,000/day; Google Books needs its own free key.

**Memory:** ~310 MB of 512 MB with the old board (re-measure); move to 1 CPU / 2 GB if logs show it running out. **Backups:** daily disk snapshots on Render, kept ≥7 days.

**Deploy:** push to `main` (~1 min downtime). **More:** `DEPLOY.md`, `README.md`, and the full architecture PDF.